



PROGRESS REPORT

Zambia: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 178 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	The National AI Strategy text was located in the copy lodged with an international policy observatory, and the ministry says the strategy is nearing the end of its cycle and due for review. The document carries no date of its own — no adoption date and no month in 121,000 characters of extracted text — and is dated here from the ministry's own launch announcement (text). It disagrees with itself about its horizon: the cover reads 2024-2026 and every running header reads 2025-2027. No first-party copy was located (text). The permanent secretary said in August 2026 that the strategy is nearing the end of its cycle and due for review; a successor reading is an inference from the dates and is stated in no source held (review , partnership , leadership). A regional artificial-intelligence strategy sensitisation workshop was launched in the capital: the country is drafting a national instrument while helping shape the regional one that would frame it (regional).	MIXED a strategy text located and held while the document carries no date of its own and disagrees with itself about its horizon
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Act 2021 is named as part of the operative framework, and a reported Cabinet repeal intent has produced nothing in sixteen months. The Act's number and year of enactment are not established beyond 2021, and the reported repeal intent has produced nothing on the record in sixteen months (framework , safeguards , freedom). A statute whose own enactment reference cannot be established, under a repeal intent that has produced nothing, is the legal basis under which the identity register, the health record and the refugee database all operate.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025 and the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 are both in force, and the investigatory and interception powers in them are court-gated. The gazetted text of the security Act was acquired from the National Assembly's own directory; it commenced on 12 May 2025 by statutory instrument (Act , signature). Enforcement of the crimes Act was declared fully operational in July 2026. The gazetted texts of both Acts are now held, and the investigatory powers in the crimes Act and the interception power in the security Act are both court-gated; the claim that the 2025 Acts authorise interception without prior judicial review is not borne out, while the presidential-control half of that claim is (enforcement , warning , compliance , freedom). The Law Association was reported set to mount a challenge in April 2025; the single held source is a lede-only capture and the absence of any subsequent record is itself the finding (challenge).	MIXED two 2025 Acts in force with their investigatory powers court-gated while a threatened legal challenge has produced no record
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The mobile money levy rate doubled during 2025, dated only to the year, and the source is an industry body arguing against such levies. The doubling is dated only to the year, so it cannot be placed inside or outside the window (levy). Naming the source's interest matters here: an industry body arguing against mobile money levies is the only account of this one, and no government or regulator statement of the rate or its yield is held.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	A Cabinet directive on open-source technology was issued to ministries, reported only in an excerpt of a trade-press article with no government publication held. It was issued alongside the spatial data infrastructure launch in June 2026 (directive). No government publication of it is held. Officials elsewhere in this ledger name fragmented, vendor-locked systems as a governance and legal problem rather than a technical one, which is the case the directive would answer — and the directive itself cannot be read.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026 went to public written submissions, replacing a 2009 Act that also underwrites postal banking and financial services. Submissions closed on 27 July 2026 (bill , submissions). The 2009 Act underwrites postal banking and financial services, so its replacement governs the postal service's agency-banking role — which makes a postal bill a payments instrument. Submissions closed one working day after the consultations ended, and it is the only open public call for written comment on a domestic instrument the base holds for the whole window (consultation).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The data protection commissioner was asked by nine civil-society organisations to examine a beneficiary contact list, and nothing in the base shows the regulator acting. The regulator exists and travels — it appeared at an international identity event — and nothing in the base shows it acting (commissioner , freedom , engagement). Tenders were opened in August 2026 for a data protection compliance management system and for guidelines consultancy; these are tenders rather than awards, with no value, delivery date or statement of the commission's current caseload or enforcement record held (tender , guidelines). A regulator with no recorded action, procuring the system that would let it record action, is the position.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	A national was elected Secretary-General of the continental telecommunications union on the fourth round, and the country gains the secretariat and loses the council seat in the same cycle. The election was won with 21 of 34 votes at a plenipotentiary conference, for a term beginning January 2027 (election , conference). A declaration on meaningful connectivity was adopted at the same conference; it is a regional commitment with no domestic implementing measure in this base (declaration , connectivity). Holding the continental secretariat while the national artificial-intelligence strategy is undated and the data-protection regulator has no recorded action is the shape of this unit's international position.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A regional programme steering committee convened in the capital, the programme's stated policy and oversight body held by a regional body rather than by member states. The third steering committee convened in July 2026, alongside the programme's annual digital forum (committee , forum , appraisal). Policy and oversight for a national digital programme sitting with a regional secretariat rather than with member states is a governance arrangement the record states and nowhere explains.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National quality standards	Quarterly network-performance reporting was announced, and a provincial minister names four districts where poor service blocks access to social cash transfers and farm input subsidies. Both regulator items behind the enforcement regime are paywalled ledes (reporting , disruption , action). Naming districts where poor service blocks social cash transfers and farm input subsidies makes quality of service a benefits-delivery question rather than a consumer one. Health ministry ICT standards issued in January 2014 are the oldest instrument in this ledger and the only national sectoral data standard the base holds for the country (standards).	ADVANCED
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	Observer missions issued preliminary statements on digital systems in the 2026 general election, and a consent judgment requires a reason for any internet interruption within 36 hours. Four observer missions and a media body issued preliminary statements in August 2026; no final observer report, government response or electoral commission account of the accreditation and register decisions is held (statements , media , registration , assessment). The consent judgment was entered after election-period blocking in August 2021 and requires a reason for any interruption within 36 hours; it is known to the base only through a coalition letter (judgment). The Human Rights Commission considered 105 alleged violations and resolved 62; the listed remedies are administrative rather than adjudicative, and no sanction, compensation or determination is reported (cases).	ADVANCED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	A K255 million digital infrastructure and quality-of-service allocation was announced as approved, with the stage unclear and no funding source named. Approved is the source's word, and whether this is a cabinet approval, an appropriation or an in-year release is not stated; the amount is carried in local currency only and no funding source is named (allocation , record). It is the only domestic financing figure in this ledger. Every other instrument here is externally financed or company-reported.	ADVANCED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Four memoranda were signed — digital identity with a neighbour, a government compact with the payments association, a bilateral between two external organisations, and a card partnership — and none publishes a value. The identity memorandum was reported signed with the signing date not established, and no value, duration or workplan is stated (identity). The payments compact followed a State House meeting with no document, value or target published (compact). The third is a bilateral between two external organisations coordinating their support to government, with no value, duration or termination terms disclosed and the text unpublished (coordination , rollout); the card partnership reports no value, volume commitment or launch product (card).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	A digital lender announced a K500m expansion on its tenth anniversary, a forward intention by the lender itself with no external financier or named recipient. The announcement was made in July 2026 (lending). Development-finance equity in the independent tower portfolio exited in March 2021 and a US\$75m loan was fully disbursed from that year (towers); the over-1,700 tower figure is the financiers' own and is not dated more precisely than 2021 (towers, loan). Two private-capital records, one an intention and one five years old, is the whole of non-state finance here.	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A digital acceleration project was board-approved in September 2025 as the fifth operation of a multiphase regional programme, with expected disbursement of US\$6 million in the lender's 2026 financial year. The programme envelope is US\$2.48bn across fifteen countries (project, appraisal, rollout). A rural connectivity project has a stated closing date of December 2025; its implementing agency is a road fund agency, which does not sit easily with the broadband description, and it should be treated as suspect before use as evidence of digital financing (rural). A regional science and technology accelerator is at expressions-of-interest stage: the fund is resourced, the delivery consortium is not chosen, and no national allocation is stated (accelerator).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Internet usage	Internet adoption has been flat across two annual readings, and mobile connections count connections rather than people. The adoption reading is cited rather than absorbed, and has been flat across two annual compilations (users , prior). Mobile connections are connections, not people, and the regulator's separate administrative series counts subscriptions per hundred inhabitants (connections). A median fixed broadband download reading is likewise cited and not absorbed (speed). Every usage figure in this unit comes from a foreign compiler rather than the national regulator.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Mobile affordability		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The backbone extension financing stood at 0 per cent disbursement as of July 2022 — the largest single undrawn digital-infrastructure commitment the base holds — and the two national fibre-length figures are irreconcilable. Corruption allegations from a former utility board chairman are on the record against the undrawn commitment (extension). Neither fibre-length figure states whether it counts backbone only or backbone plus metropolitan and access network, which is why they cannot be reconciled (length , appraisal). A second communication towers programme reached 87.8 per cent disbursement on ministry reporting through a third-party database (towers). One programme nearly drawn and one not drawn at all, both Chinese-financed, is the backbone record.	MIXED a backbone extension financed and 0 per cent drawn while the two national fibre-length figures cannot be reconciled

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A cross-border fibre interconnector was commissioned in February 2026 with no capacity, cost or funder stated, and a terrestrial cable segment is stated ready for service in 2027. The interconnector was commissioned in February 2026 (interconnector , appraisal). The cable segment's 2027 date was first stated inside the window; the position itself did not move (segment , investment). For a landlocked country these two routes are the whole of the international capacity record, and neither carries a capacity figure.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	The country is among the top three African satellite markets by June 2026 after entry in October 2023, and no national subscriber count, licence fee, contract term or procurement route is held. Market entry was October 2023 and the country ranks among the top three African markets by June 2026 (market , appraisal , chiefdom , skills). A top-three continental position with no licence fee, contract term or procurement route on record is worth stating as exactly that. Direct-to-cell satellite trials name the country as a trial site on an operator statement, with no licence, spectrum decision or trial result held (trials).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	A memorandum on a national artificial-intelligence data centre was signed with the vendor that built the existing national data centre, and it precedes the strategy that would govern it. The memorandum is not a contract; the same vendor built the existing national facility, and it precedes the National AI Strategy that would govern it (memorandum). The existing facility's phase one commenced in January 2016 under a Chinese concessional loan, and it is the only domestic data-centre facility the base describes in physical terms (centre). An edge data centre plan names the country among target countries on a company statement of intent rather than a commitment (edge).	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Grid reliability	Load-shedding is recorded as a constraint on digital services from the drought that began in January 2024, and solar power at all 116 council offices is a government self-report. The load-shedding statement comes from a lender appraisal; an eased-hours figure circulating elsewhere has no source in this base and is not carried (load-shedding). Solar power was stated complete for all 116 councils at a state institute briefing, with no capacity, cost, supplier or verification held (solar). Powering every council office while the grid constrains digital services generally is a sensible sequence, and the completion claim is the government's own.	NO CHANGE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	The government wide area network declared phase one complete in March 2026 and had border-post gaps confirmed in August, and connected has at times meant completed site works rather than live service. A primary of February 2025 establishes that connected has at times meant completed site works rather than live end-to-end service, which is the qualification every connection count in this unit needs (network , deployment , councils , expansion). A border-post connectivity upgrade across five trade corridors set a national standard and commissioned an independent audit; the audit precedes the procurement rather than following it (border). Commissioning the audit before the procurement is the right order and is unusual in this frame.	ADVANCED
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	A smart office management system demonstrated in June 2025 has not moved — the clearest pre-window baseline in this ledger that has not — and a property management system launched in May 2026. The office system was demonstrated at health ministry headquarters with one province selected as pilot, and has not moved since (office). The property management system was launched by the infrastructure ministry with the state ICT institute (property). A digital loan system for civil servants was briefed to the microfinance association at a courtesy call, with no agreement or memorandum reported (loans).	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The cyber security agency moved to new premises and issued a post-election warning, and 43,500 subscriber cards were deactivated for mobile-money fraud in six months. The agency's director general accounts for the move by saying it had been housed in the state institute's offices where space limited staff accommodation and key functions, and that the new premises let the whole team work together with access to its tools – which dates the constraint rather than measuring what it cost. No incident-response capability, staffing figure or service level is published before or after (warning , offices , trafficking). The card deactivations cover January to June 2026 and are held as a paywalled lede (deactivations). A company survey reports consumers targeted by digital fraud, with the comparison base shifted from one quarter's fieldwork window to another's (fraud).	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The government service bus onboarded eight local authorities from June 2026, and a named data-exchange layer is not the component through which the evidenced exchange work runs. Eight local authorities were onboarded from June 2026, and no held source states how a separately named government bus relates to the service bus or to the national portal (bus , statement , finances). A data-exchange layer is named in the acceleration project appraisal as a complementary platform for data integration and exchange; the exchange work that is actually evidenced runs through the service bus, not through a component of that name (layer , appraisal). Distinguishing the named component from the working one is what stops a project document being read as delivery.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The integrated registration information system reports end-to-end automation of birth and death notification under way, and the three enrolment figures held do not reconcile — a later source carrying a lower figure than an earlier one with no revision reported. A later source carrying a lower figure than an earlier one, with no revision reported by any party, is the reconciliation problem stated plainly (system , safeguards , enrolment). Procurement of an international system integrator for an open-standards identity build opened in March 2026; the card is to carry registration-card functions plus travel and private-sector service access, and delivery dates diverge between the state ICT institute and the Registrar General (procurement , training , advance). Two agencies giving different delivery dates for one credential is worth recording as the coordination question it is.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	Biometric enrolment runs against a funded baseline of 1,500,000 people with digitally verifiable identity at December 2022 and a 4,000,000 target at October 2030, and card issuance was deferred until after the August 2026 election. The enrolment figure was given by the ministry to the state broadcaster (enrolment , safeguards , switch). Biometric card issuance was deferred to after the general election (deferral). A nationwide mobile campaign for 3.5m identity documents launched for a three-month run in April 2025, and its result is the largest single unreported outcome in the pre-window base (campaign). The paper card has been in issue since before independence, on the appraisal document's own wording rather than a published commencement date (paper card).	MIXED biometric enrolment progressing against a 2030 target while card issuance was deferred past the election
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The national financial switch has its cost-reduction objective stated on record as not yet delivered, and cheque acceptance is to stop on a date sourced from a single sentence about another country. The electronic clearing house is stated as not yet live on the regional instant-payment scheme, and central bank interest in the continental system is characterised as conversation rather than commitment (switch). The cheque stop date comes from a single sentence in an article about another country, and no central bank circular is held (cheques , comparator). Ending an instrument on a date evidenced only in foreign coverage is a limit on what this report can state about the transition.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	The social cash transfer began its July-August 2026 cycle disbursement, on the ministry's own figures with no redemption rate, provider list or exclusion figure published. The cycle disbursement began in August 2026 (disbursement). A provincial minister separately names four districts where poor network service blocks access to social cash transfers and farm input subsidies, so the exclusion figure nobody publishes is the one that would measure whether the transfer arrives.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	The government payment gateway puts cumulative collections at over K8.8 billion with no stated start date, and the two digital revenue figures cover different periods and issuers. The collection total has no stated start date, so it is a cumulative figure of unknown period (gateway , appraisal , property). The two revenue figures cover different periods and issuers and are not a like-for-like series (revenue , investment , finances). A cumulative total of unknown period and two non-comparable figures are what the revenue record supports.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Financial inclusion among adults rose on a national consumer survey published by the central bank, with the survey month not stated, and securities exchange app users rose on the exchange's own registration figure. The inclusion figure is carried at year precision because the survey month is not stated (inclusion). The exchange figure is for registered users, not active traders or funded accounts (app users). Registered rather than active, and a survey with no stated month, are the two qualifications every uptake claim in this unit carries.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	A regional retail payments platform published its scheme rulebook and a gender strategy, and currency onboarding to the regional settlement system is attributed to the system's operator rather than the national central bank. The corridor with a neighbour is the one the platform runs on; no national transaction volume, participant count or fee schedule is published (platform). The currency onboarding is a statement of intent attributed to the system's operator, not to the national central bank (onboarding , switch). Card acceptance was extended to nine African markets with merchant and card counts given as the two companies' own and no country-specific figure (cards).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register	The birth registration rate is an external agency figure cited by the Registrar General, so a 50 per cent target for end-2026 has no measured mid-point on file. The rate is cited rather than measured domestically (rate , target). Civil registration runs on a three-pillar strategy stated at a continental civil registration day (registration), and a modernisation programme was launched on the same three pillars (programme). A target with no measured mid-point, four months from its date, is the position.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	The integrated land administration system went live in May 2023, and the minister told Parliament the predecessor ran with no maintenance contract from March 2022, creating a conduit for corruption. The system went live after data migration from the predecessor (system , clearance , gateway , expansion). The minister's statement that the predecessor ran unmaintained for over a year, creating a conduit for corruption, is a government account of its own prior failure and is the most specific such statement in this ledger.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A national electronic health record is deployed at about 80 per cent of health facilities, and the identity-integration account is implementer-authored and promotional with no independent evaluation held. The deployment share was reported in July 2026 (record , presentation , expansion , rural). A hospital edition pilot launched at a teaching hospital, and whether it shares the national record's fingerprint enrolment or the open-standards identifier is not established (pilot). An emergency outbreak response platform is in two-day user-acceptance testing rather than in service, with no go-live date, hosting arrangement or data-governance rule published (outbreak). Eighty per cent facility coverage is among the highest in this frame, and the evaluation behind it is the implementer's.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	A contract tracking and management system was launched with the justice ministry, held as a paywalled lede with no volume or turnaround figure published. It was launched in July 2026 (system). It is the only justice-sector system in this ledger, and what it does is known only from a headline.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	A memorandum on border post scanning and security technology was signed in August 2026, with no commitment amount, equipment specification or delivery timetable stated. It was signed on 24 August 2026 (memorandum). It sits alongside the border-post connectivity upgrade recorded separately, and no source relates the two — scanning equipment and the network it would report over, procured on different tracks.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The national portal reports over 400 services onboarded — a figure stated for the service bus, gateway, portal and payment platform together rather than the portal alone — and an electronic government amendment bill is in development. The 400-plus figure covers four systems together, not the portal alone (portal , appraisal , councils). Government services online were counted at a trade fair against a denominator that is the appraisal's estimate and is not restated in the newer figure (services). The amendment bill was presented at a stakeholder meeting, with officials naming fragmented, vendor-locked systems as a governance and legal problem rather than a technical one (bill , corruption). An online passport system launched with over 1,000 passports processed at launch (passports).	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	Eight of 116 councils are on the electronic council platform, one is live on the national portal, and all 116 are network-connected — three counts measuring three different things. Eight local authorities were onboarded to the council platform from June 2026; a March account names seven of a stated eight, and the platform's own launch date is not established (platform , councils , collections). One council went live as the first of 116 on the national portal; that is distinct from network connection of all 116 and from platform onboarding, and the three counts measure different things (portal). A constituency fund management system has data entry under way with full operationalisation stated for June 2026 (fund), and one town council was equipped with connectivity and telepresence in August 2026 with no programme size, cost or council list published (equipment).	MIXED three different council counts measuring three different things
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	Satellite terminals were installed in rural public facilities and a government private fourth-generation network launched at a teaching hospital. The state buying foreign satellite capacity for the last mile sits alongside a government-owned private network build (terminals , network). The private network launched at a teaching hospital; clinician accounts at the launch site are operator statements, and no baseline or measured outcome is held (launch , coverage). Two connectivity strategies for the same problem — buying foreign satellite capacity and building a state network — running at once, with no source relating them.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	An implementing partner published a first-hand account of artificial-intelligence automation at the National Assembly, and the same finding is reported from two other African parliaments. That the same finding appears in three parliaments makes it a pattern rather than an incident (parliament). An artificial-intelligence for public good challenge closed applications in August 2026; it is a call for applications, with no award value, cohort size or deployment commitment by any of the five institutions stated (challenge).	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	A feature-phone artificial-intelligence voice service is the only such application on file reaching people directly, and an international laboratory is on offer with no agreement signed. The voice service is cited as a deployed feature-phone application and is the only artificial-intelligence application on file reaching people directly (service). The laboratory was disclosed as an opportunity with no agreement signed; it is the only national-level artificial-intelligence institution on offer, and no domestic body exists (laboratory). A country whose only direct-to-citizen artificial-intelligence service runs over feature phones, and whose only institutional option is an offer, is where the record stands.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Control of AI abuse	A closed-circuit television bill and a national security command centre are on the record in civil-society monitoring, and the cyber agency artificial-intelligence remit is the first defined state mandate on file and is defensive. The bill and command centre are recorded in monitoring current to late December 2025 (bill). Artificial-intelligence-enabled trafficking and online scams were placed inside the cyber agency's response; it is the first defined state artificial-intelligence mandate on file, it is defensive, and it sits with the cyber regulator because no artificial-intelligence institution exists (remit , surveillance). The capital is listed among Chinese-supplied surveillance deployments in an eleven-country mapping; a widely quoted billion-dollar figure is a 2023 total across five countries, not a national figure and not current (safe city , mapping).	ADVANCED
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The regulator annual market performance report for 2022 is the latest market sizing held, with the article's own dollar conversions undated as to rate. It is the regulator's 2022 annual report, reaching the base through a news account whose dollar conversions carry no stated rate date (report). Four years without a newer regulator market report, in a unit whose usage figures otherwise come from foreign compilers, is the measurement gap at the base of this whole ledger.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	An innovation hub ran the nine-month pipeline that took a national team to global finals, and its chief executive says the talent pool is real but investment in research, technology and innovation is not. The chief executive's statement is his own account, given at the same event (hub). A digital economy incubator recruited facilitators and group coaches in August 2026; it is European Union-funded and delivered by a private hub with a non-governmental organisation, with no cohort size, budget or start date stated (incubator). One agricultural technology company exists because European traceability-compliance software was quoted at thousands to tens of thousands of dollars a month, on the founders' own account, with no revenue, farmer count, funding or independent evaluation held (company).	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A Startup Bill was named by a ministry representative — its first and only mention in the base — and a technology company listed on the domestic securities exchange. The bill's mention is the first and only one in the base (bill). The listing is described as recent (listing), and a company founded in 2025 was profiled in July 2026 (company). A continental diversity report's third edition gives the female co-founder and chief executive share; the underlying report is not held and only the trade-press account is (diversity).	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	146 officers were trained in digital skills and data protection across three district administrations — a single-province tranche rather than a coverage measure. The training covered three district administrations in one province (training). Naming it a tranche rather than a coverage measure is the point: no national civil-service digital training figure exists in this base, and 146 officers in one province cannot stand for one.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	ICT equipment was handed to a youth resource centre under a transformation centres initiative, with no cost, contract term, procurement route or trainee count published. The handover was made in August 2026 (centres , challenge). A digital literacy programme in six schools recorded core funding disbursed for the 2025 activity year; it is a commitment record rather than a delivery report, with no pupil count, equipment or outcome stated (schools). Two literacy items, neither with a published outcome, is the whole of general digital literacy here.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	A digital skills and capabilities component was board-approved within the acceleration grant, and a vendor academy training commitment was included in the artificial-intelligence data centre memorandum. The skills component was board-approved with its parent grant in September 2025 (component , appraisal). The vendor training reports no start date, cost, curriculum or intake process (academy). Both are components of larger instruments rather than programmes with their own delivery record, which is why neither carries an intake figure.	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	The revenue authority signed a research memorandum and a non-disclosure agreement, so the terms — and whether taxpayer microdata moves — are not disclosed. The memorandum and the accompanying non-disclosure agreement were signed in July 2026 (memorandum). A research agreement whose confidentiality clause conceals whether taxpayer microdata moves is worth recording as exactly that, in a country whose data-protection regulator has no recorded action.	ADVANCED

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	Transfer of the refugee registration database to the home affairs ministry is provided for as a project subcomponent, and two project documents give different card counts and values. The safeguards framework gives US\$6.5m and about 100,000 cards against the appraisal document's US\$6m and about 150,000 (transfer); the divergence is recorded, not resolved (transfer , framework , engagement). The parent project became effective in December 2024, and no disbursement figure, enrolment count or implementation progress within the window is held (project , plans). Moving a refugee database from an international agency to a ministry is a change of controller, and the country's data-protection regulator has no recorded action of any kind.	NO CHANGE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	The Universal Access and Service Fund has no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count held for any year, under 2012 regulations that are its regulatory basis. A board assessment tour of projects in three provinces took place in 2026, and no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count is held for any year (fund , projects , bill). The regulations were gazetted in June 2012 and are the fund's regulatory basis; the fund's own size, current levy collected and annual disbursement remain not held (regulations). Fourteen years of a universal access fund with no published financial figure of any kind is the single largest accountability gap in this ledger.	NO CHANGE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data		NO EVIDENCE
Open data	Use of open data	A national spatial data infrastructure policy and portal was launched, and a national carbon registry launched with counts given by the permanent secretary. The spatial policy and portal were launched in the capital; the event date is inferred from a relative reference in a June 2026 report, and the policy document itself is not held (spatial , open source). The carbon registry's launch counts — more than 90 carbon projects at stages of approval, and bilateral agreements with three European states — are the permanent secretary's own (registry , and no public access, transaction count, custodian ministry or disclosure rule for its holdings is stated (holdings). A registry of tradeable environmental assets with no published disclosure rule is worth naming as the transparency question it is.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A satellite and artificial-intelligence farm traceability platform is in use on the founder's account, with no user count, revenue or independent verification. The platform is described in a founder interview (platform). It is the only earth-observation application in this ledger, and it exists because compliance software priced for European buyers was out of reach — which makes a traceability requirement in one market the origin of a domestic technology company in another.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A United States health financing memorandum was reported shelved over data terms and a minerals precondition, and the health minister denied the mining link and was dismissed three days later without explanation. The memorandum was reported shelved in May 2026 (shelving , exploitation , rejection). The minister denied the mining link on 15 February 2026 and was dismissed three days later without explanation. The 25-year data term is reported from a leaked draft rather than a text this base holds, and the value is given as US\$1.012bn in that draft and as up to US\$2bn by the foreign minister in May 2026, with the two unreconciled (stress test , investigation). A country declining a health financing agreement over its data terms is rare in this frame and is recorded as the position it is.	STALLED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	A bilateral seminar set out sovereignty conditions for digital cooperation with no agreement signed, against Chinese financing of the national data centre, the backbone and the towers programme. Sovereignty conditions were set out at the seminar and no agreement was signed; the source body is an excerpt rather than a full capture (seminar , ties , support). The existing relationship is not a matter of intention: Chinese concessional finance built the national data centre, funded the towers programme to the disbursement level recorded elsewhere in this report and left the backbone extension wholly undrawn, and the same vendor holds the artificial-intelligence data centre memorandum. Setting conditions on future cooperation while the installed base is already Chinese-financed is the position the record supports.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Computer Incident Response Team	The full Project Appraisal Document's component text, which would state whether a national response team is funded, hosted or operating; the wiki holds only the datasheet and strategic context paragraphs	not yet probed
Central Monitoring Centre	The text of the Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025 and any commencement or establishment order; the base carries the Centre only as an embassy and civil-society characterisation, with no evidence it has been built, sited, staffed or funded	not yet probed
National cybersecurity policy or strategy	A published national cybersecurity strategy or the critical-information-infrastructure designation list required under the 2025 Act	not yet probed
Commercial and colocation data-centre capacity	A regulator or operator disclosure of installed and delivered IT load in MW, or rack count, by facility; the base holds no Zambian data-centre capacity figure of any kind after the 2015 build description	not yet probed
Government cloud and data-hosting arrangements	The state ICT institute's hosting policy or a government cloud contract stating where ministry data and the portal and service-bus workloads physically reside	not yet probed
National internet exchange point	A regulator or exchange-operator statement of peering members and traffic exchanged; the base holds no reference to a Zambian exchange point at all	not yet probed
International transit and wholesale bandwidth pricing	The regulator's annual market performance report for a year after 2022, or an operator's published wholesale tariff; the last market report the wiki holds is for 2022	not yet probed
Power supply and backup at telecommunications sites	An operator or regulator statement of site electrification, generator and battery coverage, or reported outage hours attributable to grid failure	not yet probed
Electricity supply to data centres	A utility or facility-operator statement of contracted load and backup arrangements for the national data centre and any commercial facility	not yet probed
Satellite operator licence terms in Zambia	The regulator's licence award notice or fee schedule for satellite service providers; the held market report gives a continental fee range but no Zambian figure	not yet probed
4G and mobile broadband population coverage	A regulator coverage report by technology; the government's 92% and 94% coverage claims state no unit or measurement basis	not yet probed
Fixed and mobile broadband pricing	A price basket after the 2025 appraisal's statement that 5 GB of fixed broadband costs more than 12% of gross national income per head; no post-2025 Zambian tariff figure is held	not yet probed
System integrator contract award for the digital ID	The procurement award notice naming the integrator, contract value and delivery dates; the base holds the March 2026 procurement opening and nothing after it	not yet probed
Outcome of the April 2025 mobile campaign for 3.5 million ID documents	A registration department or home affairs ministry closing report for the three-month campaign, giving registration cards and birth certificates actually issued	not yet probed
Refugee biometric registration card issuance	The refugee and host communities project implementation status report, which would show disbursement and whether biometric registration under the identity subcomponent has begun	not yet probed
Land parcels or titles held in the land administration system	A lands ministry annual report or system statistics page giving titles issued, parcels registered or digital clearance turnaround times since 2023	not yet probed
Company and business register	A registration agency annual report or registry statistics release; the agency appears in the base only as a verification call from the land system in 2023	not yet probed
ZamConnect in operation	A service catalogue or project progress report naming agencies connected to it and the volume of exchanges it carries	not yet probed
Education management information system	A Ministry of Education statistical bulletin or system description; the base carries interactive boards and school connectivity but no named school information system	not yet probed
Central bank national payment system statistics	A national payment systems annual or quarterly report giving mobile money and switch transaction volumes and values; the base carries only inclusion rates quoted second-hand	not yet probed
Whether the seven pilot councils went live on the national portal by 2026-06-30	A local government ministry statement after 2026-06-30 listing councils live on the portal	not yet probed
Statistics agency release programme	Any statistics agency publication - census release, price index or national accounts bulletin, or its statistical release calendar; the wiki holds none, and every statistics figure comes from a compiler, the regulator, an agency or a survey vendor	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Regulator annual or quarterly market performance report after 2022	A market performance report for 2023 or later; the only one held is the 2022 edition	not yet probed
A national earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A Zambian space or earth-observation policy, a national satellite data agreement, or the spatial data portal's dataset inventory naming its imagery sources	not yet probed
Data Protection Act statutory instruments and regulations	The Government Gazette carrying the Act's commencement order and any statutory instruments made under it on registration of controllers, transfer rules and breach notification	not yet probed
Data protection regulator enforcement record	The Office's annual report or a published register of controllers, complaints, breach notifications and enforcement decisions	not yet probed
Cabinet decision to repeal and replace the Data Protection Act 2021	The Cabinet decision or the gazetted amendment or repeal Bill; the base carries only a civil-society report's statement of intent, current to late 2025	not yet probed
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text	The gazetted text of the Act, which would establish whether the interception mandate and central monitoring centre attributed to it are provisions of the Act	not yet probed
Enforcement outturn under the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025	Charge, prosecution or conviction figures from the National Prosecution Authority or the Judiciary, or a ministerial statement to the National Assembly giving counts since 2026-07-18	not yet probed
Access to information law	A gazetted Access to Information Act or Bill; no held source states whether Zambia has one, and the base carries no position at any date	not yet probed
National data-sharing, interoperability or data-classification standard	A state ICT institute published interoperability framework or government data standard; the base holds only a 2014 health-sector standard	not yet probed
Ratification of the AU Malabo Convention	The African Union list of signatures, ratifications and accessions, or a Zambian instrument of ratification	not yet probed
Parliamentary and public contestation of Zambia's data governance	Hansard for the sittings at which the cyber Acts and the data protection Act were debated; the base holds two sources on this subject and one is a paywalled lede	not yet probed
National open data portal and open data policy	A government open-data portal with a dataset inventory and licence terms, or a Cabinet-approved open data policy; the base holds only the geospatial portal	not yet probed
EU-Zambia digital cooperation	A European Commission or EU Delegation announcement, Global Gateway project fiche or financing agreement naming a Zambian digital investment; the base holds zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed
Legal basis for personal-data transfers between Zambia and the EU	A European Commission adequacy decision, or a Zambian data protection determination or guidance on cross-border transfer mechanisms	not yet probed
Any Gulf-state technology engagement with Zambia	A bilateral agreement, investment record or ministerial visit involving the UAE, Saudi Arabia or Qatar; nothing on file, the base holding zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence budget line or implementation costing	The 2026 or 2027 national budget estimates showing an AI allocation, or a costed implementation plan annexed to the strategy	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence institution or agency	A statutory instrument or cabinet decision establishing a Zambian AI body; nothing names one, and the only institution on offer is the proposed international lab	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence compute inventory	A state ICT institute or ministry statement of installed government compute, or the technical annex to the vendor memorandum	not yet probed
Government innovation or venture fund	A budget line, fund charter or disbursement record; the base holds no Zambian public innovation fund of any kind	not yet probed
Technology hub inventory	A directory or count of Zambian innovation hubs; one hub is named anywhere in the base, and long-standing hubs appear nowhere in it	not yet probed
Zambian startup funding totals	The underlying diversity report, or an African startup funding report with a Zambia line; only continental aggregates are held	not yet probed
ICT sector contribution to GDP	A statistics agency national-accounts release with an ICT sector share; the Presidential Delivery Unit called ICT one of Zambia's fastest-growing sectors with no figure behind it	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Ministry of Technology and Science annual appropriation	Zambia's Estimates of Revenue and Expenditure for FY2025 and FY2026, head-level lines for the technology ministry and the state ICT institute; there is no domestic budget archive for Zambia	not yet probed
Universal Access and Service Fund accounts	The regulator's annual report or the fund's own audited financial statements, giving the levy rate, fund balance and annual disbursement	not yet probed
State ICT institute appropriation and project counterpart funding	The acceleration project financing agreement or the estimates line showing the government's counterpart contribution against the US\$100 million grant	not yet probed
National digital literacy rate or programme	A regulator or statistics agency ICT household survey reporting digital skills prevalence, or a named national digital-literacy curriculum document	not yet probed
University or national ICT research institute	A named research centre's establishment instrument, funding line or publication record; no Zambian research institution appears in any held source	not yet probed
Digital skills targets under the e-Government Plan 2023-2026	The plan itself, which the hub names but no held source reproduces or quantifies	not yet probed
Gender gap in internet use or mobile ownership	An industry association gender-gap country figure or a regulator or statistics agency survey disaggregating internet use by sex	not yet probed
Rural-urban internet use split	A regulator market report or household survey disaggregating internet use by residence; the base gives only that 52.4% of the population is rural	not yet probed
Device affordability and data cost as a share of income	An affordability alliance or ITU affordability figure for Zambia; the base holds only the appraisal statement that fixed broadband exceeds 12% of gross national income per head	not yet probed
Digital access for persons with disabilities	A national disability-inclusion policy or regulator programme document; the base holds only individual ICT donations to two special schools	not yet probed

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.